

6.3a

The style of business reports

Worksheet

- A** Look at the three sentences below. Underline examples of the techniques in the box.

1 The passive 2 'It' + passive 3 Compound nouns

- a *It is recommended that sales reports are produced on a monthly basis.*
- b *It is vital that the construction project is managed properly.*
- c *The planning decision will be made in June.*

- Try rewriting the sentences without using any of the three techniques. Is it always possible?
- Using the techniques in the box is a choice the writer makes. How does the writer choose?

- B** These two texts have exactly the same meaning. What is the difference between them?

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| <p>1 Effective report writing depends on good planning and the writing technique of the author. While writing, a good English-English dictionary should be used, and the habit of looking carefully at the example sentences must be developed. It can be said that there are no easy rules for report writing, but an ideal improvement opportunity is to do some writing practice on a Business English course. Improvement will only be made after a few reports have been written and the problem areas have been worked on.</p> | <p>2 The writing of effective reports depends on good planning and the technique of writing of the author. While writing, you should use a good English-English dictionary, and you must develop the habit of looking carefully at the sentences which are examples. I can say that there are no easy rules for the writing of reports, but an ideal opportunity for improvement is to do some practice in writing on a course of Business English. You will only improve after you write a few reports and work on the areas which are a problem.</p> |
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Write a third text with the same meaning, using a combination of phrases from the other two texts. Choose the phrases that you think are the simplest and clearest. The correct answer is a matter of personal opinion.

- C** Rewrite the following sentences in a formal, impersonal style.

- 1 We prohibit smoking in the areas which are public.

Smoking _____

- 2 Somebody suggested that the campaign for the advertising should run for a period of six months.

It was suggested that _____

- 3 We might consider using a different format for the sales account that we make annually.

A different format _____

- 4 We agreed we should give the contract for cleaning the offices to KleanUp.

It was agreed that _____

- 5 We delayed the project to construct a dam because of regulations about planning.

The dam _____